NCFE Level 2 Functional Skills Qualification in English (603/5054/4)

Reading

Paper number: Practice paper 02

Mark Scheme v1.0

The practice paper pass mark is intended for guidance purposes only. A practice paper will give learners an indication of their current level of performance rather than an official assessment result.

Practice Paper Level 2 Reading pass mark: 17

For office use only — Paper Code Practice paper 02

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Section 1

1	Give **one** quotation from Text 1 that shows how being around dogs improves people's wellbeing. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • 'They provide us with the companionship we need / to feel happy and relaxed, (and this is why many families and home workers have dogs as pets and companions') (1) • ('Perhaps this is not surprising, considering that scientific studies show that) working with dogs can increase collaboration and reduce stress' (1) • 'They help make my staff more fulfilled / (and) happier at work, (and they get more done in a day)'. (1) **Accept** any other valid quotation.	1	2.11

2	What does the word 'pool' mean, as used in paragraph 5 of Text 1? You may use a dictionary to help you answer this question. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • team (1) • quantity (1) • group of people. (1) **Accept** any other valid meaning in the context of the text.	1	2.15

3	Which **one** of the following quotations shows a humorous style of writing? **[1 mark]** **A** Cats use our houses in the same way that some teenagers use their family home **B** It seems that allowing dogs at work increases productivity **C** Smaller businesses and offices have caught on to the idea **D** This company is convinced it encourages employees to work longer hours		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	A Cats use our houses in the same way that some teenagers use their family home (1)	1	2.19

4	Give **two** quotations that imply the writer of Text 1 is a dog lover. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • 'Imagine the fun you'd have working there' (1) • 'Dogs, however, are friendly, loyal and need lots of love and exercise' (1) • 'I'd want to spend most of the day cuddling them!' (1) • 'Why not take your canine buddy to work?' (1) **Accept** any other valid quotation.	2	2.13

5	State whether **each** of the following quotations from Text 1 is an example of a **fact** or an **opinion**. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks for:	2	2.18

Quotation	Fact or opinion
Some major businesses now allow us to bring our dogs to work	**Fact**
It's too easy to be distracted by dogs at work	**Opinion**

Section 2

6	What does the word 'bonded' mean, as used in the 'Maintaining workplace standards' section of Text 2? You may use a dictionary to help you answer this question. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • got on well (1) • become friends (1) • connected (1) • become attached. (1) **Accept** any other valid meaning in the context of the text.	1	2.15

7	Give **one** quotation for **each** of the following features used in Text 2. (a) Rule of three **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • ('As we settle into our new building and find our feet, we need to consider our 'normal' ways of working, including) productivity, maintaining equipment, and standards' (1) • ('We understand that working from home has improved your quality of life through) more time at home, fewer hours spent commuting and reduced travel costs' (1) • ('There are the issues of) hygiene, sanitation and smells'. (1) **Accept** any other valid quotation for rule of three.	1	2.14
	(b) Short sentence **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • 'Reported sickness has been reduced' (1) • 'Many people now have dogs.' (1) **Accept** any other valid quotation up to 10 words.	1	2.14

8	Give **two** reasons why Charlie Barr thinks employees should continue working from home. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • productivity is high / at a good level (1) • it has allowed employees to remain close to their dogs (1) • reported sickness has been reduced. (1) **Accept** any other valid reason.	2	2.18

9	(a) Which organisational feature is used to summarise why staff will not be allowed to bring their dogs to work? **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • bullet points / bulleted list. (1) **Accept** similar wording.	1	2.16
	(b) Which section mentions upgrades? **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • Maintaining tech. (1)	1	2.16

10	In the email, Charlie Barr gives information about returning to the office. Which **two** of the following quotations from Text 2 show that she might be biased in favour of working from home? **[2 marks]** **A** We cannot, however, implement a 'Bring Your Dog to Work' scheme **B** We have been happy to approve more requests for working from home **C** We have to consider our business and customer needs **D** We realise that this will come as a disappointment to some of you **E** We understand that working from home has improved your quality of life		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	B We have been happy to approve more requests for working from home (1) **E** We understand that working from home has improved your quality of life (1)	2	2.17

11	Which **one** of the following statements about Text 1 **and** Text 2 is true? **[1 mark]** **A** Both advise that flexible working hours reduce sickness rates **B** Both explain the findings of scientific studies **C** Both give information about challenges for workers who have dogs **D** Both persuade readers that dogs should be allowed in the workplace		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	C Both give information about challenges for workers who have dogs (1)	1	2.12

Section 3

12	Identify whether **each** of the following quotations from Text 3 is an example of a **light-hearted** tone or a **serious** tone. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks for: **Quotation** / **Light-hearted or serious** Inclusiveness includes our four-legged friends — **Light-hearted** It would never be possible to allow dogs in places such as hospitals — **Serious**	2	2.19

13	Identify the language feature used in **each** of these quotations from Text 3. (a) 'welcoming workplace' **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • alliteration. (1)	1	2.14
	(b) 'tell your employer' **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • imperative. (1) **Accept** direct address.	1	2.14

14	Use Text 3. Which section gives the reader practical advice about having dogs at work? **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • The evidence. (1)	1	2.16

15	What does the writer imply in **each** of these quotations? (a) 'Family, friends and wellbeing come first.' **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • that work should not be the main focus of life (1) • family, friends and wellbeing are more important than work. (1) **Accept** any other valid answer.	1	2.13
	(b) 'Life is boring without our best friend by our side' **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • dogs are our 'best friends' (1) • dogs make people happy (1) • people can feel very attached to their dogs. (1) **Accept** any other valid answer.	1	2.13

16	Identify **two** challenges faced by people returning to the workplace. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • workers are used to getting up later for work (1) • the work atmosphere feels strange (1) • people are used to working from home (1) • family, friends and wellbeing are now more important. (1) **Accept** any other valid answer.	2	2.11

17	Which **two** of the following quotations from Text 3 use informal language to talk about dogs? **[2 marks]** **A** Employers should allow employees to bring their dogs to work **B** Only house-trained pets should be permitted in the workplace **C** The furry one with the waggly tail and a wet nose is part of the family **D** This includes the increasing number of dogs in our families **E** We fight for the rights of your pups and pooches too		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	C The furry one with the waggly tail and a wet nose is part of the family (1) **E** We fight for the rights of your pups and pooches too (1)	2	2.17

18	Identify whether **each** of these statements about Text 2 **and** Text 3 is **true** or **false**. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks for: **Statement** / **True or false** Both texts say that more people want to work from home — **True** Both texts say that owning a dog increases a worker's productivity — **False**	2	2.12

[Total: 30 marks]